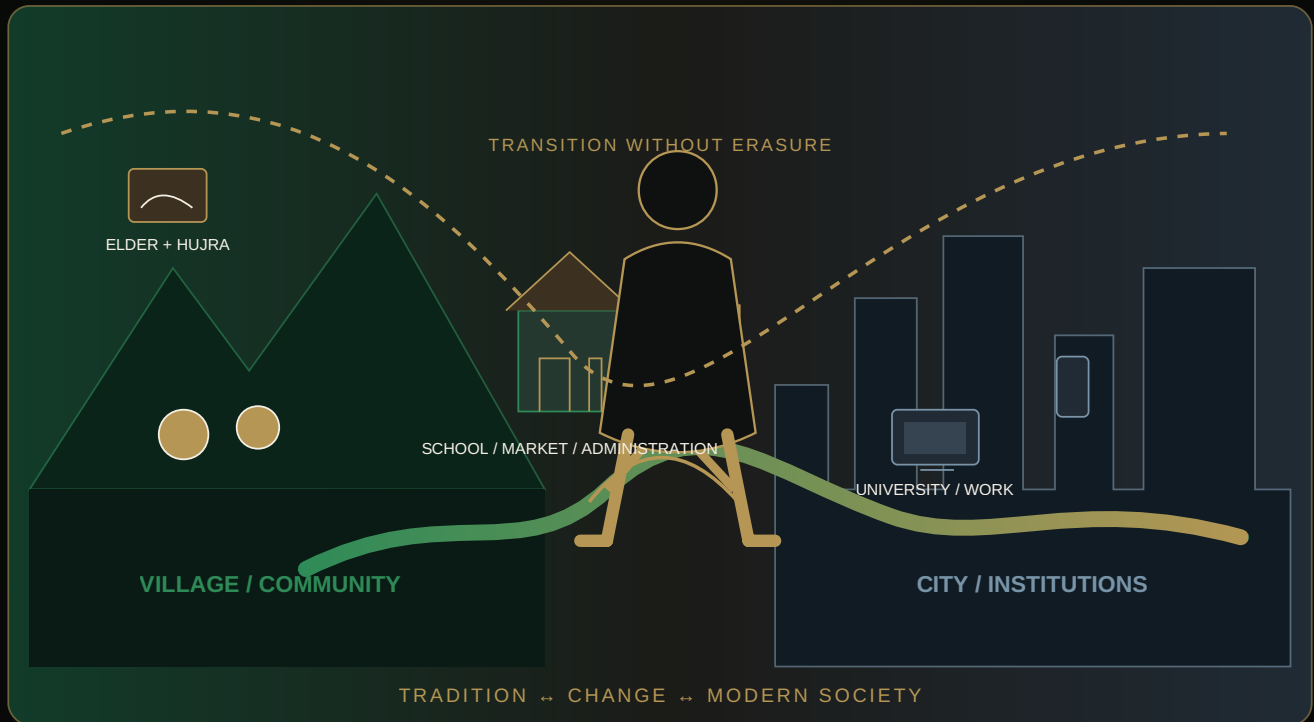


FROM TRIBAL SOCIETY TO MODERN SOCIETY

“A society can change without forgetting where it came from.”



A society can change without forgetting where it came from. Traditional and modern institutions are connected through a long social transition.

LOGIC ATLAS: SOCIAL TRANSITION

These 65 original SVG graphics translate the page's reasoning into compact, printable structures. They distinguish documented administrative and development evidence from interpretive frameworks about continuity, adaptation, and social change.



FAMILY

EXTENDED FAMILY

URBAN FAMILY

DIGITAL FAMILY

13. Family — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MARRIAGE

FAMILY VALUES

EDUCATION + MIGRATION

INDIVIDUAL PREFERENCE

14. Marriage — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

BIRTH

LIFE-CYCLE TRADITION

HEALTHCARE + REGISTRATION

FAMILY CONTINUITY

15. Birth — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

DEATH AND MOURNING

CONDOLENCE

RELIGIOUS OBSERVANCE

URBAN / DIASPORA CONTACT

16. Death and mourning — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

HOSPITALITY

MELMASTIA

MODERN LIFE

ADAPTED HOSPITALITY

17. Hospitality — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

EDUCATION

KNOWLEDGE

OCCUPATION

MOBILITY + ASPIRATION

18. Education — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

SCHOOL PATHWAY

HOME

SCHOOL → COLLEGE

UNIVERSITY → PROFESSION

19. School pathway — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

WOMEN'S EDUCATION

GIRLS' EDUCATION

SKILLS + HEALTH

OPPORTUNITY — BOUNDED

20. Women's education — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

YOUTH

TRADITION

EDUCATION + TECHNOLOGY

NEW POSSIBILITIES

21. Youth — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

SMARTPHONE

CONTEMPORARY DIGITAL LIFE

UNEQUAL ACCESS

22. Digital transformation — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

DIGITAL SKILLS

TRAINING

SKILLS

OPPORTUNITY — NOT GUARANTEE

23. Digital skills — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

VOCATIONAL TRANSFORMATION

TECHNICAL TRAINING

MOBILE / SOLAR SKILLS

LIVELIHOOD PATHWAY

24. Vocational transformation — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

ECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION

LOCAL ECONOMY

MOBILITY + EDUCATION

DIVERSIFIED POSSIBILITIES

25. Economic transformation — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MARKETS

ROAD + TRANSPORT

PHONE + PAYMENT

URBAN / DIASPORA LINKS

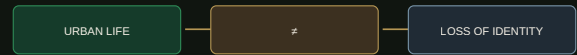
26. Markets — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MIGRATION



27. Migration — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

URBANIZATION



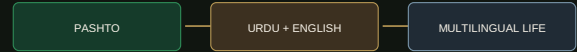
28. Urbanization — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

DIASPORA



29. Diaspora — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

LANGUAGE



30. Language — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

RELIGION



31. Religion — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

TRADITIONAL VALUES



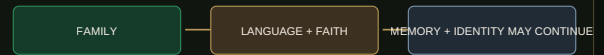
32. Traditional values — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

WHAT CHANGES



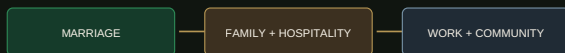
33. What changes — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

WHAT CONTINUES



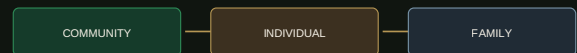
34. What continues — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

WHAT ADAPTS



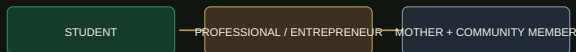
35. What adapts — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

INDIVIDUAL AND COMMUNITY



36. Individual and community — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

WOMEN AND SOCIAL CHANGE



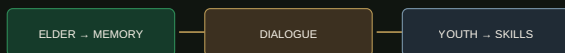
37. Women and social change — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MEN AND SOCIAL CHANGE



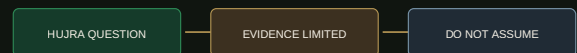
38. Men and social change — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

ELDERS AND YOUTH



39. Elders and youth — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MODERN HUJRA



40. Modern Hujra — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MODERN JIRGA

CUSTOMARY MEDIATION — FORMAL COURTS — COEXISTENCE TO STUDY

41. Modern Jirga — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

COMMUNITY ORGANIZATIONS

SCHOOL / NGO — YOUTH / PROFESSIONAL — COMMUNITY ACTION

42. Community organizations — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMMES

STABILIZATION — LIVELIHOODS + GOVERNANCE — CONTEMPORARY INTERVENTION

43. Development programmes — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

LAW AND RIGHTS

CUSTOM — LAW + RIGHTS — INSTITUTIONAL LIFE

44. Law and rights — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

CITIZENSHIP

LEGAL IDENTITY — RIGHTS + SERVICES — CIVIC RESPONSIBILITY

45. Citizenship — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

TRIBE TO DISTRICT

TRIBAL IDENTIFICATION — DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION — MULTI-LAYERED IDENTITY

46. Tribe to district — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

SOCIAL CHANGE IS NOT LINEAR

TRADITION ➤ ADAPTATION — MODERNITY

47. Social change is not linear — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

GENERATIONAL DIVIDE

GRANDPARENTS — PARENTS — CHILDREN

48. Generational divide — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

CULTURAL IDENTITY

LANGUAGE — MEMORY + FAMILY — FAITH + CHOICE

49. Cultural identity — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

PRESERVATION

ORAL HISTORY — RECORD + ARCHIVE — LIVING HERITAGE

50. Preservation — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

REFORM

DIGNITY — QUESTION HARM — INCLUSION

51. Reform — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

HUMAN RIGHTS

HERITAGE — HUMAN DIGNITY — EQUAL RIGHTS

52. Human rights — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MODERN SOCIETY CHALLENGES

OPPORTUNITY — INEQUALITY + DIVIDE — INSTITUTIONAL PRESSURE

53. Modern society challenges — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

TRIBAL SOCIETY COMPLEXITY

COOPERATION — HIERARCHY + CONFLICT — SOLIDARITY + INEQUALITY

54. Tribal society complexity — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

MODERN SOCIETY COMPLEXITY



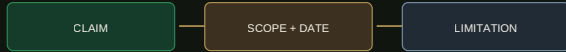
55. Modern society complexity — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

BALANCED MODEL



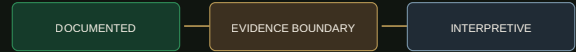
56. Balanced model — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

EVIDENCE MATRIX



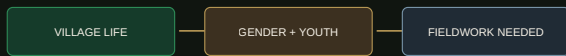
57. Evidence matrix — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

DOCUMENTED VS INTERPRETIVE



58. Documented vs interpretive — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

RESEARCH GAP



59. Research gap — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

ORAL HISTORY



60. Oral history — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

PAST-PRESENT-FUTURE



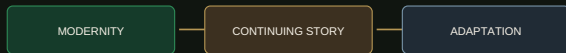
61. Past-present-future — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

REMEMBER-ADAPT-BUILD



62. Remember-adapt-build — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

FINAL STATEMENT



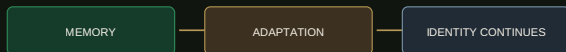
63. Final statement — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

SOCIAL TRANSITION FORMULA



64. Social transition formula — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

CHANGE WITHOUT ERASURE



65. Change without erasure — conceptual framework; scope and evidence are stated in the prose.

Societies do not change in a single moment.

A road can change how a village connects to a market. A school can change how a child imagines a future. A university can change the professions available to a family. A smartphone can change how relatives communicate. Migration can place one family

across several cities. A new law can change the institutions through which people interact with the state. And a new generation can change traditions simply by living them differently.

Orakzai society has experienced many such changes. The old structures did not disappear overnight. The new structures did not arrive complete. Between them exists a long period of adaptation.

This is the story of a society moving from one social framework toward another — while carrying memory, family, language, faith, and identity along the way.

WHAT WAS “TRIBAL SOCIETY”?

The phrase must be used carefully. Traditional Orakzai and Pashtun community organization could include family networks, kinship, lineage, clan relationships, elders, jirga, hujra, hospitality, customary norms, religious institutions, local leadership, collective responsibility, and community cooperation. These were social structures, not a single identical system lived in exactly the same form by every person or village. Historical community life contained cooperation and conflict, solidarity and hierarchy, mediation and competition, hospitality and inequality. The task is neither to romanticize nor condemn it. A careful account asks how particular institutions worked, for whom, under what conditions, and how their roles changed.

WHAT IS MODERN SOCIETY?

Modern society can involve formal institutions, constitutional citizenship, education, urbanization, professional occupations, markets, technology, mass communication, mobility, formal law, public administration, and digital connectivity. It does not mean Westernization, the loss of Pashto, the loss of family, the loss of religion, or the loss of cultural identity. Modernity is a social process, not a moral ranking. A community can have traditional family relationships, modern education, digital communication, customary practices, and formal legal institutions at the same time. Modernity is not the end of tradition; it is one way people adapt inherited lives to changing institutions and conditions.

KINSHIP AND COMMUNITY

Kinship historically influenced identity, marriage, mutual support, social relationships, alliances, and community responsibilities. Pages 31–40 described

ELDERS, JIRGA, AND HUJRA

Elders could, often, or in some communities provide advice, mediation, memory, custom, and coordination. Not every elder possessed formal authority. A

tribe, lineage, family, and social structure. Page 101 adds a caution: kinship can shape the social field without determining every person's modern choices.

Family → kinship → community is a useful model, not a universal rule.

Education, migration, urbanization, employment, digital communication, and personal preference can widen a person's relationships while family ties remain important.

jirga can be understood as a customary deliberative institution in Pashtun social contexts, but jirgas are not identical everywhere and are not equivalent to Pakistan's formal courts.

A hujra may serve hospitality, social interaction, community discussion, and cultural transmission. Not every Orakzai village maintained an identical hujra, and contemporary Orakzai research on how hujra institutions adapt to urbanization and digital communication remains limited. The responsible answer to "Did the hujra move into digital groups?" is: this requires evidence, not assumption.

CUSTOM, RELIGION, AND STATE LAW

Customary norms, religious values, and state law have interacted in complex ways. Pashtun custom is not identical to Islamic law. Tribal custom is not identical to formal Pakistani law. Islamic law is not a synonym for either. The three categories may meet in lived practice, but they must be distinguished analytically and documented with care.

This distinction matters because a social practice may be described as customary without being treated as legally binding; a religious interpretation may influence community life without being identical to an ethnic tradition; and constitutional

FROM FCR TO CONSTITUTIONAL GOVERNANCE

Before the merger, former FATA operated through a distinct constitutional and administrative framework in which the Frontier Crimes Regulation was central. The Twenty-fifth Constitutional Amendment of 2018 brought the former FATA areas into Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.¹ This created a new formal framework of provincial institutions, courts, public administration, and citizenship. The reform was a major legal and administrative transformation, not the completion of social transformation. A constitutional change can establish new institutions while social adaptation

rights may provide standards that cannot be reduced to local custom.

continues for years. Pages 73–80, 85, 86, and 100 provide the historical path into this transition.

AGENCY TO DISTRICT

The administrative vocabulary changed from Orakzai Agency to Orakzai District. In analytical terms, agency → district and exceptional administration → provincial institutional framework describe a shift in formal governance. They do not describe every change in daily life, every public service, or every relationship between residents and institutions.

Modern society introduces additional institutional channels: district administration, courts, elected representatives, local government, schools, health services, and public offices. These channels do not automatically eliminate elders, jirga, hujra, family networks, or

FAMILY, MARRIAGE, BIRTH, AND MOURNING

Family life can adapt to education, migration, urbanization, employment, technology, work schedules, smaller households in some settings, and long-distance networks. It is not accurate to claim that all families have become nuclear. Marriage remains important while education, urban life, migration, and individual preferences may influence how families approach it; universal change cannot be claimed.

Birth and life-cycle traditions can continue while families use urban hospitals, modern healthcare, birth registration, education, and digital communication. Funeral

religious institutions. The question is how the channels interact, overlap, and sometimes conflict.

gatherings, religious observance, community condolences, and family support can also connect village, city, and diaspora households. No Orakzai-specific statistic is invented.

HOSPITALITY IN MODERN LIFE

Melmastia can survive in a village home, city apartment, restaurant, workplace, or diaspora household. The setting may change while the ethical meaning of welcoming and caring for a guest may continue in adapted form. This is an interpretive framework, not a claim that every modern encounter is identical to a traditional guest relationship.

Adaptation is often the mechanism through which traditions survive. A practice can change its venue, timing, tools, or participants without becoming meaningless. It can also be questioned

EDUCATION AS THE GREAT TRANSFORMER

Formal education can change knowledge, occupations, mobility, social networks, aspirations, women's opportunities, political awareness, and economic possibilities. It does not guarantee employment. A possible pathway is home → school → college → university → profession, but apprenticeships, technical training, religious learning, family knowledge, and self-directed study also matter.

A 2020 UN Women report provides development context for women and girls

when it creates harm or exclusion. Continuity should be described with “may continue,” not assumed for every person.

in Orakzai, while a UNDP/UNICEF/KP education programme is documented in the project research as a targeted intervention in Kurram and Orakzai. Programme participation is not converted into district-wide outcomes.

WOMEN AND YOUTH

Girls’ education, skills development, health, professional opportunities, and community participation are significant dimensions of social change. Women may be students, teachers, health professionals, entrepreneurs, workers, mothers, community members, and technology users. Modernization changes opportunities and expectations without reducing women to a development problem.

Youth increasingly interact with universities, digital platforms, professional networks, national institutions, and international opportunities. Tradition +

DIGITAL AND VOCATIONAL TRANSFORMATION

Smartphones, internet, WhatsApp, social media, online education, digital payments, remote work, and digital services are contemporary possibilities with uneven access. In November 2024, a UNDP/ Japan-supported programme reported 700 young participants from Kurram and Orakzai, including 375 women, trained in market-oriented vocational and technical skills such as mobile-phone repair, solar-related work, and other practical skills.² In April 2025, UNDP reported 600 young people from Kurram and Orakzai trained in digital skills, with women comprising 52%

education + technology can create new social possibilities. The 2024 vocational and 2025 digital-skills programmes are evidence of specific development initiatives, not district-wide employment or skills statistics.^{2 3}

of participants.³ Each number refers to a programme cohort. Neither is evidence that all Orakzai youth are digitally skilled, that 52% of Orakzai youth are in training, or that training automatically produces employment.

ECONOMY, MARKETS, MIGRATION, AND CITIES

Economic life may combine agriculture, trade, construction, transport, public employment, professional services, technology, entrepreneurship, and remittances. No occupation is claimed to dominate. Roads, transport, mobile communication, digital payments, urban connections, and diaspora networks can expand market possibilities, but documented conditions must be separated from future potential.

Migration can transform family structures, occupations, education, language use,

DIASPORA, LANGUAGE, AND RELIGION

Migration does not necessarily end community identity. Digital communication can support family contact, religious celebrations, financial support, cultural exchange, and oral-history preservation. Pages 90, 97, 98, 99, and 100 distinguish Orakzai-specific evidence from broader Pakistani, Pashtun, and diaspora context.

Pashto, Urdu, English, and other languages may be used differently at home, school, work, in media, and across locations. No disappearance of Pashto is predicted.

social networks, and economic expectations. Village ↔ city ↔ overseas is a connected pathway, not a one-way exit. Urban Orakzai life can involve different workplaces, schools, housing, social networks, and cultural environments while cultural identity continues. Urban life is not loss of identity.

Modernization also does not automatically mean secularization: people may participate simultaneously in religious life, modern education, professional work, digital society, and state institutions.

WHAT CHANGES, CONTINUES, AND ADAPTS?

Technology, education, work, mobility, law, and communication can change. Family, language, faith, memory, hospitality, and identity may continue. Marriage, family, hospitality, work, community, and cultural practice can adapt. These are analytical categories, not universal measurements. Individual choice may expand in education, career, location, marriage, and lifestyle while family and community relationships remain important.

ELDERS, YOUTH, AND COMMUNITY ORGANIZATIONS

Social transition does not require one generation to defeat another. Elders may contribute memory and experience; youth may contribute skills and technology; dialogue can create intergenerational learning. Contemporary organizations may include schools, parent groups, NGOs, youth groups, professional associations, sports organizations, and community development groups. Their reach and impact require local documentation.

Individualism has not simply replaced collectivism. A better model is community
↑ individual ↑ family.

The 2022 UNDP/Japan programme for merged districts focused on stabilization, economic recovery, social cohesion, local governance, and livelihood opportunities, with planned employment opportunities for 1,300 youth through digital skills, incubation, and skills training.⁴ It is a contemporary development intervention, not proof that it transformed all of Orakzai society.

LAW, RIGHTS, AND CITIZENSHIP

Modern civic life can be represented as custom + law + rights + institutions. Constitutional rights, legal identity, political representation, public services, and civic responsibilities form a multi-layered citizenship. Tribal identification, district administration, provincial citizenship, and national citizenship can coexist. The transition from exceptional arrangements toward constitutional governance is historically significant, but it should not be declared fully complete without evidence.

MODERN SOCIETY IS NOT PERFECT

Modern society can create opportunity, mobility, education, rights, and technology while also producing inequality, unemployment, migration pressure, infrastructure gaps, digital divides, education gaps, institutional weakness, environmental pressure, isolation, misinformation, cultural fragmentation, and urban stress. These are challenges to document, not local statistics to invent. Traditional society was not simple, and modern society is not simple. Both can

Human dignity and equal rights provide an ethical boundary. Cultural heritage should not be used to justify harm, discrimination, exclusion, unsafe practice, collective punishment, or denial of individual rights. Reform can be compatible with cultural dignity when it protects people rather than attacking their identity.

contain cooperation and conflict, solidarity and inequality, belonging and pressure. The balanced model is past + present + future, followed by remember + adapt + build.

MODERNITY AND CULTURAL IDENTITY

A society does not lose its identity simply because its institutions change.

Identity can survive in language. It can survive in memory. It can survive in family relationships. It can survive in stories. It can survive in faith. It can survive in the choices people make about what they carry forward.

Preservation may prioritize language, oral histories, family memory, historical records, hospitality, poetry, music, traditional knowledge, and community solidarity. Reform may address unsafe

practices, discrimination, exclusion, barriers to education, harmful stereotypes, collective punishment, and denial of individual rights. Not every historical practice should remain unchanged.

TRANSITION EVIDENCE MATRIX

The table distinguishes a traditional framework from a modern development pathway without implying that one simply replaced the other.

SOCIAL DIMENSION	TRADITIONAL FRAMEWORK	MODERN DEVELOPMENT	EVIDENCE	SCOPE	CONFIDENCE
Kinship	Family, lineage, mutual support	Wider school, work, urban, digital networks	Ahmed; project’s family/tribal chapters	Historical and analytical	Contextual
Elders	Memory, advice, mediation could occur	Intergenerational dialogue	Page 66; oral-history framework	Not every elder/formal authority	Contextual
Jirga	Customary deliberation and mediation	Coexistence with courts and administration	Pashtun/FATA scholarship	Not identical everywhere	Contextual
Hujra				Orakzai village-level	Limited

	SOCIAL DIMENSION	TRADITIONAL FRAMEWORK	MODERN DEVELOPMENT	EVIDENCE	SCOPE	CONFIDENCE
		Hospitality, discussion, transmission	Contemporary adaptation requires research	Page 24; evidence gap stated	evidence limited	
	Customary norms	Local social practice	Interaction with rights and state law	Pages 73–80; legal sources	Not identical to religion or law	High for distinction
	Formal law	FCR-era exceptional framework	Constitutional/KP institutional framework	Twenty-fifth Amendment	Former FATA / KP	High
	Administration	Agency / Political Agent framework	District administration and public institutions	Official constitutional record; Pages 85–86	Formal governance	High
	Education	Family, local, religious, practical knowledge	Schools, colleges, universities, technical training	UN Women; development programmes	Programme/ context-specific	Contextual
	Women’s education	Historically variable and under-documented	Targeted girls’ education and skills initiatives	UN Women; UNDP programmes	Project-specific	Bounded
	Youth development	Family and community learning	Digital, vocational, professional pathways	2024 and 2025 UNDP programmes	Kurram/ Orakzai cohorts	High, bounded
	Migration	Local mobility and kinship networks	Village ↔ city ↔ overseas networks	Pages 89, 97–99	Orakzai/ Pakistani/ diaspora distinctions	Contextual
	Urbanization	Village-based community spaces	New schools, work, housing, networks	Pages 92–96	City-specific evidence	Contextual
	Language	Pashto and local oral transmission	Multilingual home/ school/work/media use	Pages 28, 63, 99	No disappearance claim	Contextual
	Religion	Religious institutions and values	Coexistence with education, work, digital life	Page 70; identity framework	Not a secularization claim	Contextual
	Markets / employment	Local agriculture, trade, transport, crafts	Technical skills, services, digital possibilities	2024 UNDP; Page 50	No occupation dominance stated	Bounded

SOCIAL DIMENSION	TRADITIONAL FRAMEWORK	MODERN DEVELOPMENT	EVIDENCE	SCOPE	CONFIDENCE
Citizenship	Tribal and local belonging	Rights, legal identity, representation, public services	2018 constitutional framework	Transition ongoing	High for framework
Diaspora	Extended family and homeland ties	Digital contact, remittances, cultural exchange	Pages 97–99	No global tribe-specific count	Contextual

DOCUMENTED VS INTERPRETIVE

Documented: the 2018 constitutional merger; formal administrative change; targeted education and development initiatives; the 2024 vocational programme; the 2025 digital-skills programme; migration and urbanization as established book themes; and the existence of modern institutions.

Interpretive / conceptual: identity adaptation; intergenerational negotiation; changing family expectations; tradition-modernity coexistence; the possibility of a modern hujra; and future cultural preservation. Interpretation is labelled as interpretation. It is not presented as a measured district-wide fact.

WHAT STILL NEEDS TO BE DOCUMENTED

Village-level social change; the changing role of jirga; the changing role of hujra; family structure; marriage decisions; women’s experiences; youth aspirations; education outcomes; professional mobility; digital access and behaviour; migration and return migration; diaspora relationships; language change; religious practice; customary law; formal court use; community organizations; economic transformation; entrepreneurship; agricultural modernization; urban identity; and intergenerational relationships.

From tribal society to modern society is not a single historical event. It is an ongoing social process that requires continued fieldwork, oral history, demographic research, and community-based documentation.

ORAL-HISTORY QUESTIONS

1. What was community life like when you were young?
2. What role did elders play?
3. What role did the hujra play?
4. How were community disputes handled?
5. What role did jirga play?
6. What has changed since your childhood?
7. When did schools become more important?
8. How has migration changed families?
9. How has urban life changed Orakzai identity?
10. How has the internet changed communication?

11. What traditions remain strong?
12. What traditions have changed?
13. What traditions have disappeared?
14. What role do women have today compared with the past?
15. What opportunities do young people have today?
16. What opportunities were unavailable to earlier generations?
17. What role does religion play in modern life?
18. What role does Pashto play today?
19. What should young people preserve?
20. What should young people change?
21. What does “modern Orakzai” mean to you?

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

Every generation believes it is living through an unprecedented change.

Perhaps every generation is partly right.

The Orakzai world I inherit contains many worlds at once.

There is the memory of elders. There is the language of the home. There are mountains, villages, and family histories. There are schools, universities, and professional careers. There are cities, migration routes, and overseas communities. There are smartphones, digital platforms, and new forms of work.

None of these worlds exists completely alone. They overlap.

The modern Orakzai therefore cannot be understood by looking only at the past or only at the present. We have to look at the connection between them.

A society becomes modern not when it forgets its roots, but when it learns how to carry those roots into institutions, education, technology, and a changing world.

The responsibility of my generation is not simply to inherit a culture. It is to understand it. To preserve what gives dignity. To question what causes harm. To learn what the future requires. And to leave the next generation something stronger than what we received.

**MODERNITY IS NOT THE END OF TRADITION.
IT IS THE CONTINUING STORY OF HOW PEOPLE ADAPT.**

REFERENCES AND EVIDENCE NOTES

- ¹ Government of Pakistan, *Constitution (Twenty-fifth Amendment) Act, 2018*, official constitutional record: [National Assembly PDF](#). It supports the administrative merger; it does not support a claim that social adaptation ended or tribal identity disappeared.
- ² UNDP Pakistan, “Transformative step towards a resilient Khyber Pakhtunkhwa: 700 young people have acquired market-driven skills through vocational training,” 22 November 2024: [UNDP press release](#). The 700 and 375 figures refer to the reported programme cohort from Kurram and Orakzai.
- ³ UNDP Pakistan, “600 young people from Kurram and Orakzai trained in digital skills,” 17 April 2025: [UNDP press release](#). The 600 and 52% figures refer to the identified training cohort only.
- ⁴ UNDP Pakistan / Government of Japan, “UNDP and Government of Japan to work together for stabilization, economic recovery and local governance in the merged districts,” 30 November 2022: [UNDP programme announcement](#). Planned opportunities are not presented as completed district-wide transformation.
- ⁵ Akbar S. Ahmed, *Pukhtun economy and society: Traditional structure and economic development in a tribal society*, Routledge, 2011 edition: [bibliographic record](#). Used as foundational academic context, not as a current Orakzai survey.
- ⁶ UN Women, *Status of Women and Girls in Orakzai District*, 2020: [UN Women report](#). Used as development context; it is not treated as a current universal outcome dataset.
- ⁷ Pages 24, 28, 47, 49, 50, 53, 56–59, 63–70, 73–80, 83–91, 92–100 provide internal continuity. Internal page references do not replace direct evidence and do not justify universal claims.